

customers want, access to every blockchain. It could be two guys in a garage that forked bitcoin and had this genius idea and people want to try that out. We don't want to have any barriers. We're open to all. We help even the smallest players onboard.”⁹

Just as the Internet and World Wide Web changed how we live our lives and interact with others, it also made millionaires out of the innovators who began companies based on these technologies—and the investors who invested in them. Those with the foresight to have bought Google during its “Initial Public Offering” (IPO) would have seen a 1,800 percent appreciation by August 2016, and those who bought Amazon's IPO would have seen a 1,827 percent appreciation.¹⁰

Blockchain architectures and their native assets are well on their way to becoming the next great meta-application to leverage Internet infrastructure. They already provide services that include global currencies, world computers, and decentralized social networks, among hundreds of others.

The native assets historically have been called cryptocurrencies or altcoins, but we prefer the term cryptoassets, which is the term we will use throughout the book. The terms *cryptocurrencies* and *altcoins* convey only a fraction of the innovation that is occurring in the cryptoasset economy. Not all of the 800 existing cryptoassets are currencies. We are not just witnessing the decentralized creation of currencies but also of commodities and polished digital goods and services, as blockchains meld technology and the markets to build Web 3.0.